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AFP file

HOW TRUMP VANISHED FROM AIR FORCE ONE AMID IRAN THREAT LAST MONTH

■ US President Donald Trump was secretly moved off Air Force One in an airport catering vehicle in Turkey last month after officials deemed an Iranian threat credible. He was flown to Britain aboard a military aircraft while the presidential jet carrying journalists served as a decoy. After arriving separately, Trump was secretly returned to Air Force One before emerging for cameras, creating the impression he had travelled aboard it. The extraordinary operation involved three aircraft. The picture shows the catering truck beside Air Force One that was used to secretly move Trump in Turkey.

SEE ALSO P6

GARGASH: REGION CANNOT BE IN 'NO WAR, NO PEACE' STATE

UAE urges lasting stability as unease persists

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R
Senior Associate Editor

The Middle East must move beyond its prolonged state of “no war, no peace” towards sustainable stability built on international law, peaceful coexistence and respect for sovereignty, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has said.

His comments come as efforts to end the Iran conflict and fully reopen the Strait of Hormuz remain stalled, while renewed Houthi attacks threaten another important shipping route.

Clarity of vision needed

“The region cannot remain indefinitely in a state of neither war nor peace; its stability and the future of its people require clarity of vision and direction,” Gargash said in a post on X.

“At the same time, the next phase cannot be built on fragile foundations or arrangements detached from international law, the principles of peaceful coexistence, respect for sovereignty and the logic of peace. The goal is to move towards sustainable stability governed by clear and shared rules,” he added.

Dr Gargash’s remarks come at a particularly uncertain moment for the region.

Since the United States and Israel launched the war against Iran on February 28, US Presi-

The competing US, Iran demands threaten to push an agreement further out of reach as disruption to Hormuz drives up fuel prices and rattles the global economy.

dent Donald Trump has alternated between threats of escalation and predictions that a peace agreement is close.

A US-Iran ceasefire agreed in June failed to produce lasting stability. Attacks on commercial vessels in the Strait of Hormuz subsequently triggered renewed US strikes, while Tehran again declared the strategic waterway closed and Washington reimposed its blockade on Iranian shipping.

Trump keeps military option open

Trump sharpened his rhetoric again yesterday, calling Iranian negotiators “devious” and “dishonest” in an interview with *Real America’s Voice*.

He said Washington could continue applying economic pressure or “hit them really, really hard”.

Trump described Iran’s economy as “a mess” and claimed Washington controlled Tehran’s access to money. “I’m their banker,” he said.

The comments came despite Trump saying over the weekend that he was “low-keying” his approach to Iran, suggesting

he was prepared to let economic pressure mount rather than immediately resort to further military action.

Meanwhile, negotiations remain complicated by competing demands for compensation.

Iran wants war reparations, an end to US sanctions and the lifting of Washington’s blockade before normal traffic through Hormuz resumes.

Trump responded on Monday with demands of his own.

“I am likewise demanding compensation from Iran,” he said, later adding: “We’re going to ask for money for the damage they’ve done over a 50-year period.”

The competing demands threaten to push an agreement further out of reach as disruption to Hormuz drives up fuel prices and rattles the global economy.

Red Sea danger grows

Instability is also spreading beyond Hormuz.

Yemeni authorities said four people, including three Pakistanis, were killed yesterday when Iran-backed Houthi militants fired three ballistic missiles at a commercial vessel in the Bab Al Mandeb strait.

They were the first known deaths from renewed Houthi attacks on shipping in the latest escalation.

The Bab Al Mandeb and Red Sea have become increasingly important alternative routes as Iran restricts traffic through Hormuz.

SEE ALSO P6

Music licensing fees to be rolled out soon

Restaurants, hotels, malls to be affected

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Restaurants, cafés, hotels, shopping malls, fitness centres and airlines across the UAE will come under a new music licensing fee framework from December 2026, following the launch of rules governing the commercial use of music.

The Ministry of Economy and Tourism said yesterday that the Collective Management Guide for Music will also cover floating hotels, radio stations, television channels, concerts and similar events where the use of music is linked to copyright and related rights.

Fee brackets will vary according to the nature of the music use and the size of the economic activity, although the Ministry did not provide individual fee amounts in its announcement.

The framework was issued under Ministerial Resolution No 136 of 2026 and is intended to stand-

ardise licensing criteria while setting out how payments linked to music rights will be collected and distributed.

Management activities

Implementation will begin at the start of December, with the Emirates Music Rights Association and Music Nation responsible for collecting the fees and managing the associated rights.

Both organisations have received permits from the Ministry to conduct collective management activities in music, including the collection and distribution of payments to creators and rights holders in the UAE.

Licences will be issued for one year and can be renewed in accordance with the applicable rules and conditions.

Educational and academic institutions, government entities, music used during national occasions and personal celebrations or events of a non-commercial nature will be exempt under the framework.

More than 44,000 workers receive compensation in H1

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

The UAE’s worker protection system delivered more than Dh832 million in compensation to workers during first half of 2026, as authorities stepped up efforts to safeguard labour rights, strengthen financial security and improve workplace wellbeing.

The Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation (MoHRE) said more than 44,000 workers benefited from the Workers Protection Programme, receiving over Dh320 million in compensation by the end of June. Separately, the Unemployment Insurance Scheme paid more than Dh512 million to workers who lost their jobs from the beginning of 2024 through the first half of 2026.

Dalal Alshehhi, Assistant Undersecretary for Labour Protection at MoHRE, said the results demonstrate the ministry’s commitment to creating a working environment that pro-

pects workers’ interests while maintaining a balance with employers’ rights.

Reflecting commitment

“The positive results recorded in the first half of 2026 reflect our commitment at the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation to fostering a safe, stable, and sustainable work environment,” she said.

The Ministry’s digital and field inspection systems also supported implementation of the Occupational Heat Stress Prevention Policy, which runs until September 15. As part of the policy, more than 12,000 rest stations are planned for delivery riders during the period, providing workers with designated areas to rest and recover from high temperatures.

Worker welfare has also been supported through improved labour accommodation standards. The number of accommodation facilities registered in MoHRE’s Labour Accommodation System exceeded 2,800 by the end of June. These facilities provide accommodation for around two million workers and are subject to standards covering comfort, health and safety.

NATION

Dubai’s subletting, sharing rules: All you need to know | P2



ENTERTAINMENT

Ricky Balshaw takes on disability myths with dark humour | P11

BUSINESS

Dubai gold prices hit 2-month high amid August rebound | P-1

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A state of emergency has been declared | P8-9

